

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1991-09-11

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

dear b ahá'í f riends,

The historic Arc and Terraces projects are now advancing at full speed,
ress being made.

The work is planned to proceed in several distinct phases. phase one
involved the strengthening and facing of the two-hundred-meter-long re-taining wall
supporting the main Terrace of the Shrine of the báb. This
work continued in spite of many difficulties during the gulf crisis and has
now been completed.

phase T wo, the contract for which was signed on 17 june 1991, as already
announced, involves the excavation for the center for the Study of the Texts
and the Archives extension, the extension eastwards of the main Terrace of
the Shrine of the báb, and the completion of eight of the Terraces below
the Shrine. work is currently in progress in three main areas, as explained
below.

on the site of the center for the Study of the Texts and the Archives
extension a security fence has been erected around the work area to separate
it from the Archives building and the gardens below the Arc path. Access
roads have been opened to permit removal of excavated material. The first stage of
excavation has been completed and rock bolts have been installed,
allowing the construction of the first retaining wall to begin.

The extension of the main Terrace of the Shrine of the báb eastward to
make it symmetrical with the western half will provide a large underground storage area of
great practical use in the care of the gardens. The excavations
for this extension have now been completed and foundations are being laid.113.3

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message from The Universal House of Justice

28 On the site of the Terraces from the Shrine of the Báb leading down to 'Abbás Street, over two hundred valuable trees were carefully dug up and have been temporarily replanted on the Temple land until they can be returned to the area of the Terraces after regrading of the mountainside.

Now the remaining trees, undergrowth, topsoil and existing structures have been removed. The material from the excavations on the Arc is being moved

to this area to provide the fill needed for the Terraces.

Phase Three will involve the construction of the center for the Study of the Texts and the Archives extension, and is scheduled to begin in July 1992. It is to be followed by several other phases to complete the projects, and announcements about these will be made in due course.

It can thus be seen that the work is in full flow. The flow of funds to finance the work must likewise be uninterrupted. The Universal House of Justice is confident that the followers of Bahá'u'lláh will bend every effort to bring to speedy completion this stage in the fulfillment of the beloved Guardian's vision of the establishment of the World Administrative Center of the Cause of God. It assures the friends in every land of its ardent prayers in the Holy Shrines for the successful completion of the great enterprises before the Bahá'í world at one of the most critical periods in human history.

With loving Bahá'í greetings,

Department of the Secretariat

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Appointment of New Continental Counselor

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]